

1607–1776

THE AMERICAN TAVERN — 10 FUNCTIONS IN ONE BUILDING

TAVERNS: HOME TO A NEW WORLD



COURT OF LAW

Legal proceedings, trials, and magistrate hearings were held in tavern meeting rooms



BANK

Tavern keepers acted as intermediaries for loans and the exchange of goods and currency



POST OFFICE

Mail collection and distribution centered on the tavern — news arrived and departed here first



TOWN HALL

Town meetings, civic debates, and government assemblies were convened in tavern meeting rooms



HOSPITAL

Sick and injured travelers received care at taverns — their only refuge in many early settlements



LIBRARY

Pamphlets, newspapers, and books circulated through the tavern — literacy spread from these tables



STORE

Goods were bought and sold; auctions were held. Tavern keepers were early America's arbitrators.



GARRISON

Military units used taverns as staging points; and organized battle plans there



SCHOOL

In areas without formal schools, basic instruction and public lectures took place at taverns



INN + TAVERN

Food, drink, lodging, warmth, and community — the original product that started everything

1634

Samuel Cole opens Boston's first licensed tavern, Cole's Inn, on March 4th

Source: *Star Tavern*, startavern.net

1 PER 130

Ratio of taverns to residents; mandated by law in colonial New England settlements

Source: *Colonial Williamsburg Foundation*; *Gettysburg Historical Journal*

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Towns without a tavern were sanctioned — the tavern was critical to commerce

Source: *Star Tavern*, startavern.net